

Md. Zahedul Islam

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Senior Business Professional

- Well-rounded business generalist with 16+ years' experience in turnarounds, problem solving, leading projects, and developing talents for nation's fast- paced progressive organizations ranging from FMCG to B2B to Startup.
- Currently working at Minimal Ltd – an emerging lifestyle products brand, as the COO. Prior to that, worked at Enroute - a leading consulting, as the GM. Served career's first 8 years at BAT Bangladesh in different GM/ leadership roles.

Competencies

- **Can lead Business, Projects and people:** Can drive multiple angles and teams to deliver shared objectives based on insights & forecasting, structured planning, execution & PIR. Led both company managers & 3rd party activation teams.
- **Skilled for Interview & Assessment:** Trained to hire right people through crafting and executing scientific approaches.
- **Understands Organizational Value Chain:** Expert in process & structure, crafting efficiency enhancement projects; Exposures in Marketing, Strategy, Growth, Partnerships, Retail, RTM, and knowledge in Org. value chain/big picture.
- **Can drive Transformation, Strategies & Campaigns:** Experienced in leading transformation thru adapting automation & tech; Process improvement and Innovation; Strategy, campaign planning, and activation; New product launch etc.

Awards

- **FZA**: Best central marketing initiative (PRISM), 2015-16; Best RTM efficiency enhancement initiative (CTG), 2012.
- **YES Award:** Best marketing project/ initiatives. Tier 2 – Price stabilization in post PI, Excalibur- 3rd party pay structure, Area share leadership, BCP in political turmoil, 2013-15; Tier 1– RTM overhaul in rural market, 2013.

Professional Experiences

MINIMAL LTD, Bashundhara R/A - Dhaka, Bangladesh – Technology based architectural consultancy, interior design and futuristic lifestyle products brand.

1. Chief Operating Officer, 02/2020 to Present, manage others role.

The COO role is about leading the overall planning and action of the business model, reporting to the board. It is a start-up initiative. Goal is to solve real life problems, ensure high growth utilizing limited resources, while sustaining the right culture.

ENROUTE INTERNATIONAL LTD, Baridhara DoHS-Dhaka, Bangladesh – Fast-growing org, one of the reputed in the industry, providing business consultancy and outsourcing services.

1. General Manager, 05/2019 to 01/2020, manage others role.

Worked as the business head for the largest SBU, outsourcing services, that contributes ~80% of the overall org. revenue. Spread and scale of this unique role ranges from problem solving; decision making based on analytics; strategy & execution planning; new business, partnerships & growth; budget & P&L; process innovation; to people development.

Selected Accomplishments:

- Led a business of more than 3.5K outsourced people for 30+ Local, MNC and iNGO clients with 15+ direct reporting team members across the nation.
- Led the rigorous development of the young team, HRIS implementation and excellence in B2B service agenda.

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2. Senior Management Consultant, 08/2017 to 04/2019, manage others role.

Lead role in formulating strategic and futuristic projects for both B2B clients and internal requirements in the fields of planning & insights; business development and execution; crafting new venture business cases, strategies, and innovation.

Md. Zahedul Islam

P2 ● +880 1713 235642

BRITISH AMERICAN TOBACCO, Mohakhali DoHS-Dhaka, Bangladesh – Multimillion-dollar Company, manufacturing and selling tobacco products.

1. Regional Operational Lead - SAM**,** 03/2016 to 07/2017, Job Grade-35 manage others role (Rajshahi Regional HQ).

Senior level GM/ strategy role, responsible to operationally lead the nation's largest region by geographic spread and outlet universe. Led a business of over 190 MN GBP annual turnover, 3000+ activation people, 14 districts, and 28 BAT managers.

Selected Accomplishments:

- Led the overall business operation consists of strategies & campaigns; partnerships & communication; share & value growth; internal and external stakeholders, budget and P&L management; and the talent development agenda etc.
- Led double digit volume (17%) and GTO (22%) growth with a +2 ppt share growth vs. SPLY. Led successful launch of 5 major campaigns. i.e. nationally best in consumer acceptance- B&H stick upgrade; 10% SoS from competition- Derby special; complex change management ensuring zero sales loss- Graphical health warning; nationally 2nd highest volume base- JPGL Switch; and fastest right stick price compliance in the nation.
- Led the regional strategic roadmap for 16- 17 to set the direction, alignment and execution plans. Driven the unit's talent development agenda and contributed in shipping talents to take up bigger challenges and roles.

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2. Distribution Development Executive, 09/2015 to 02/2016, Job Grade-34 manage self-role (Dhaka HQ).

Central Business, market & system development role with exposure to the big picture to handle national scale strategic projects. Responsible for BATB RTM strategies; Trade automation & Tech; Distributor and S&D process; Trade platform & agency management- using integrated approaches to create balanced campaigns for both customers to build their businesses, and also to transform the traditional organizational business practices.

Selected Accomplishments:

- Led the transformation in the way of life for BAT trade team by heading 1st ever project of its kind- PRISM that Pioneered automation in the local tobacco industry and made the decade old trade eco-system future-fit. The project enabled the sales call and analysis process to take paradigm shift from a paper-based approach to a completely digital approach using devices. Led the end-to-end change management, campaign design, implementation & PIR.
- Delivered two national campaigns (i.e. National field force promotion, B2B platform EC&C wave-2015/16), and completed a yearly cycle of distributor evaluation process-2015/16. Led and developed 3rd party trade agencies, managed global scale visits (i.e. BAT ASPAC Regional Strategic Unit etc.) and regularly presented in central forums.

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3. Marketing Project Executive, 11/2014 to 12/2014, Job Grade-34 manage self-role (Dhaka HQ).

Central special project role under the Marketing communications unit, responsible to work as a team member to develop, plan, present and execute the assigned high impact time bound project.

Selected Accomplishments:

- Successfully completed 2 months long central team assignment and operationally led the "Project Excalibur" - to redesign and to transform the pay-structure of marketing agencies from commission to a performance-based model.

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4. Area Manager, 06/2013 to 08/2015, Job Grade-34 manage others role (Khulna, Dhaka HQ).

First level GM/ strategy role, responsible to lead the business and people of few most important markets for BAT, and also to prepare for taking high impact central roles in future. Responsibility was to lead business consists of strategy, campaigns, team development, share growth, and stake holder management etc. through operational planning and execution.

Selected Accomplishments:

- Achieved the nationally highest share growth of 2.7 ppt in avg. Jan-Sep'15 for Dhaka South area vs. YTD SPLY.
- Achieved the first ever market leadership of Kushtia area through initiating different projects (i.e. Project SPADE/ACE).
- Managed global/ national scale visits (i.e. BAT group chairman, BAT Global Head of Trade, BATB Managing Director etc.); developed and shipped talents to different regions and roles.

Md. Zahedul Islam

P3 ● +880 1713 235642

5. Territory Officer, 11/2009 to 05/2013, Job Grade-33 manage self-role (Khulna, Chittagong Regional HQ).

Entry GM role in marketing function responsible for field level execution supervision, leading business within defined area demarcation. This corporate entry position is enriched with numerous opportunities for learning and self-development.

Selected Accomplishments:

- Achieved market leadership, led Distributor changeover, executed important visits, managed 3rd party activation teams.

Recognized Projects

Title	Details	Organization
PRISM: Pioneering Sales Automation	Leading Transformation thru automation and technology	BAT
Excalibur: PBIS for marketing agencies	Redesign and transform the 3rd party pay-structure	BAT
ACE: RTM Overhaul	Market rationalization, Performance improvement	BAT
Business Continuity Plan (BCP)	Performance optimization in the context of disruption	BAT
Resurgence, CTG Makeover: Efficiency+	Changeover initiative for non- performing markets	BAT
HRIS implementation	Automation to digitize business process	Enroute

Professional Training

Title	Institution	Mode
Business Analytics Specialization	Wharton, by Coursera	Online
Bangladesh Labor Act	Enroute	Classroom
Interview & Assessing Skills	Enroute	Classroom
Self-Awareness, Authenticity, and Leadership	LinkedIn Professional	Online
Effective External Stakeholder Engagement	BAT Bangladesh	Classroom
Product Knowledge; Integrity & Traceability	BAT Bangladesh	Classroom
POSITIVE Programme; Are you in control	BAT Bangladesh	Classroom
Leading Self; Leading Teams; Effective teamwork	BAT Bangladesh	Classroom
Marketing Excellence Series; Segmentation; Retail Audit	BAT Bangladesh	Classroom / Online

Basic Skills

Software/Others: MS Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint), Business Case, Presentation, campaign AV, Content/Visual.
Language: Bangla (Native standard), English (Business Standard).

Education

Year	Degree	Concentration	Result	Institution
2004-09	BBA	Major: Marketing, Min: Finance	3.47/4	Khulna university, Business Administration School, Khulna.
2003	HSC	Science	3.70/5	Govt. Science College, Dhaka.
2001	SSC	Science	4.50/5	Motijheel Model High School, Dhaka.

References

MD. HASAN TAREQ Director, Minimal, Bashundhara R/A-Dhaka. Cell: +880 1722 543358	**SHAHREEN SHABNAM** Head of HR & Admin, Kallol Group, Tejgaon-Dhaka. Cell: +880 1720 117330	**NUMAYER ALAM** Head of Trade and Planning, BAT Bangladesh, Mohakhali DOHS-Dhaka. Cell: +880 1711 430631